IMIPRAMINE

Nocturnal enuresis

Fatal in overdose

CHEMICAL NAME 3-(10,11-dihydro-5H-dibenzo[b,f]azepin-5-yl)-N,N-dimethylpropan-1-amine (hydrochloride)

CLASS Tricyclic antidepressant (TCA)

TRADE NAMES Tofranil · Imipramine (generic) · Depsonil

THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Depression (second-line).
- Nocturnal enuresis in children (when alarm/desmopressin fail).
- Panic disorder; neuropathic pain (off-label).

PHARMACODYNAMICS

- Inhibits **NA and 5-HT reuptake**; anticholinergic (↑ bladder capacity, ↓ detrusor contractions); ↓ REM sleep.

ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** at bedtime (enuresis) or divided doses (depression).
- Enuresis: max 3 months then reassess.

SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Dry mouth, constipation.
- Drowsiness, dizziness.
- Sweating, tremor.

ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Cardiac arrhythmias; overdose fatal (children's accidental ingestion).
- Seizures.
- Mood changes, suicidality.

DOSAGES

- **Depression:** 75 mg/day, increase to 150–200 mg in divided doses.
- **Enuresis:** 6–7 yr 25 mg; 8–11 yr 25–50 mg; >11 yr 50–75 mg — at bedtime.
- **Elderly:** 10–25 mg.

CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- Recent MI, arrhythmias.
- MAOIs; mania.
- Severe liver disease.

KEY INTERACTIONS

- As amitriptyline: MAOIs, anticholinergics, QT drugs, CYP2D6 inhibitors.

PHARMACOKINETICS

- **Onset:** enuresis days; depression 2–4 weeks.
- Metabolised to active desipramine (CYP2D6, 1A2).
- **t½:** 9–24 h.

NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Store securely at home (child overdose danger).
- Monitor pulse, BP, mood.
- Bladder diary for enuresis.

PATIENT EDUCATION

- Keep tablets locked away — small amounts are dangerous to children.
- Give at bedtime.
- Report fast heartbeat or fainting.

KEY POINTS

- TCA used for childhood enuresis.
- Anticholinergic.
- 25–75 mg at bedtime by age.
- Overdose very dangerous; store securely.